

Day 32 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Fundamental Duties and Directive Principles of State Policy

READING MATERIAL

Covers Part IVA (Article 51A, Fundamental Duties of citizens) and Part IV (Articles 36-51, Directive Principles of State Policy — goals/duties of the STATE). Real exam evidence shows the two are frequently tested AGAINST each other via mix-up traps, not just individually.

Q: Real exam: When and how were Fundamental Duties incorporated into the Constitution, and which Committee recommended them?

A: By the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976 (Part IVA, Article 51A) — confirmed by a real exam question. The Swaran Singh Committee (1976) recommended their inclusion (also confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question).

Q: How many Fundamental Duties are there now, and what changed this count?

A: Originally 10 (added in 1976); an 11th was added by the 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 — making it the duty of every parent/guardian to provide educational opportunities to their child/ward aged 6 to 14 years (mirroring Article 21A's Right to Education).

Q: Real exam: Which of these are GENUINE Fundamental Duties — protecting sovereignty/unity/integrity of India; protecting and improving the natural environment; preserving the rich heritage of composite culture; safeguarding PRIVATE property?

A: The first three are genuine Fundamental Duties. 'Safeguarding PRIVATE property' is NOT — the real duty (Article 51A(i)) is to safeguard PUBLIC property and abjure violence. A real exam tested exactly this public-vs-private substitution as the false statement.

Q: Real exam: Is 'to promote international peace and security' a Fundamental Duty of citizens?

A: NO — this is a classic mix-up trap. Promoting international peace and security is actually a DIRECTIVE PRINCIPLE (Article 51, a duty of the STATE), not a Fundamental Duty of citizens (Article 51A). A real exam confirmed this is the one NOT a Fundamental Duty among several options.

Q: Are Fundamental Duties legally enforceable in court?

A: No — they are moral/civic obligations, non-justiciable (cannot be enforced by a court of law), unlike Fundamental Rights.

Q: Real exam: What are the Directive Principles of State Policy, conceptually, and which Article range covers them?

A: Articles 36-51 (Part IV) — confirmed by a real exam. Conceptually, the framers used DPSP to incorporate the DUTIES OF THE STATE into the Constitution (distinct from Fundamental Rights, which are enforceable claims of citizens against the State) — also confirmed by a separate real exam question framed exactly this way.

Q: Real exam: Which Article states that the State shall strive to secure a social order for the promotion of the welfare of the people?

A: Article 38 — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: How are the Directive Principles broadly classified (an unofficial but commonly-tested classification)?

A: Socialist principles (e.g. Articles 38, 39, 41, 42, 43, 47 — economic equality, livelihood, equal pay, workers' welfare); Gandhian principles (e.g. Articles 40, 43B, 46, 48 — village panchayats, cooperatives, welfare of weaker sections, animal husbandry); and Liberal-Intellectual principles (e.g. Articles 44, 45, 48A, 50, 51 — uniform civil code, early childhood education, environment protection, separation of judiciary from executive, international peace).

Q: Are Directive Principles legally enforceable, and how do they relate to Fundamental Rights when the two conflict?

A: No — DPSPs are non-justiciable (Article 37 explicitly says so), unlike Fundamental Rights. Historically, courts have worked to harmonise the two rather than treat them as opposed; landmark cases (e.g. Kesavananda Bharati, Minerva Mills) established that Parliament cannot use DPSPs to override the 'Basic Structure', but later amendments and rulings have also expanded DPSP's persuasive weight in interpreting Fundamental Rights.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Fundamental Duties were incorporated into the Constitution of India by:

A. 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976 ✓

B. 43rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1977

C. 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978

D. 45th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1980

Explanation: 42nd Amendment, 1976. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. The recommendation to add Fundamental Duties to the Constitution came from the:

- A. Dhar Commission
- B. Mandal Commission
- C. Swaran Singh Committee ✓**
- D. Ashok Mehta Committee

Explanation: Swaran Singh Committee. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. Choose the TRUE statement(s) about Fundamental Duties: (1) To protect the Sovereignty, Unity and Integrity of India. (2) To protect and improve the Natural Environment. (3) To preserve the rich heritage of our composite culture. (4) To safeguard private property.

- A. (1) and (2) only
- B. (2) and (3) only
- C. (1), (2), and (3) only ✓**
- D. (2), (3), and (4) only

Explanation: (1), (2), and (3) are real Fundamental Duties; the real duty is to safeguard PUBLIC property, not private. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. Under the Indian Constitution, which of the following is NOT a Fundamental Duty? (a) To protect and improve the natural environment. (b) To safeguard public property and abjure violence. (c) To promote international peace and security.

- A. (a) only
- B. (a) and (b)
- C. (c) only ✓**
- D. (b) and (c)

Explanation: (c) is a Directive Principle (Article 51), not a Fundamental Duty of citizens. [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. The 11th Fundamental Duty — making it a parent/guardian's duty to provide educational opportunities to their child aged 6-14 — was added by:

- A. 42nd Amendment, 1976
- B. 73rd Amendment, 1992
- C. 86th Amendment, 2002 ✓**
- D. 101st Amendment, 2016

Explanation: 86th Amendment, 2002. [medium, web-research]

6. Fundamental Duties are:

- A. Enforceable by the Supreme Court under Article 32
- B. Enforceable by any High Court under Article 226
- C. Non-justiciable moral/civic obligations ✓**
- D. Enforceable only during a National Emergency

Explanation: Non-justiciable. [medium, authored]

7. The framers of the Constitution incorporated the duties of the STATE into the Constitution in the form of the:

- A. Fundamental Duties
- B. Fundamental Rights
- C. Directive Principles of State Policy ✓**
- D. Rights of Citizens

Explanation: Directive Principles of State Policy. [medium, question-bank-2024]

8. Directive Principles of State Policy are covered under which Articles?

- A. Articles 12-35
- B. Articles 36-51 ✓**
- C. Articles 51A only
- D. Articles 52-78

Explanation: Articles 36-51. [medium, web-research]

9. Which Article directs the State to strive to secure a social order for the promotion of the welfare of the people?

- A. Article 36
- B. Article 37
- C. Article 38 ✓**
- D. Article 39

Explanation: Article 38. [medium, question-bank-2022]

10. Article 40, which directs the State to organise village panchayats, is classified under which category of Directive Principles?

- A. Socialist principles
- B. Gandhian principles ✓**
- C. Liberal-Intellectual principles
- D. Federal principles

Explanation: Gandhian principles. [hard, web-research]

11. Are Directive Principles of State Policy legally enforceable in a court of law?

- A. Yes, always
- B. No — they are non-justiciable ✓**
- C. Only during an Emergency
- D. Only if Parliament passes an enabling law

Explanation: Non-justiciable (Article 37). [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Number Series

READING MATERIAL

Number Series is the final Reasoning skill. Real exam evidence shows 6 distinct underlying patterns: second-difference (difference-of-differences) sequences, sum-of-consecutive-cubes, geometric progression, arithmetic progression, n^2 multiples, and prime-number-squared sequences — recognize the pattern TYPE before trying to compute term-by-term.

Q: Method — sum of consecutive cubes: Find the next term: 9, 35, 91, ?

A: Each term is $n^3 + (n+1)^3$: $1^3 + 2^3 = 1 + 8 = 9$ ✓, $2^3 + 3^3 = 8 + 27 = 35$ ✓, $3^3 + 4^3 = 27 + 64 = 91$ ✓. Next: $4^3 + 5^3 = 64 + 125 = 189$.

Q: Method — second-difference (arithmetic sequence of differences): Fill in the blank: 1, 6, 15, 28, 45, ____, 91.

A: Differences: $6 - 1 = 5$, $15 - 6 = 9$, $28 - 15 = 13$, $45 - 28 = 17$ — these differences themselves increase by 4 each time. Next difference = $17 + 4 = 21$, so the blank = $45 + 21 = 66$. (Check: $91 - 66 = 25 = 21 + 4$ ✓ consistent.)

Q: Method — sequence of squared primes: Find the missing number in the sequence of squared prime numbers: 4 (2^2), 9 (3^2), 25 (5^2), 49 (7^2), ?, 169 (13^2).

A: The base numbers are consecutive primes: 2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13. The missing term corresponds to $11^2 = 121$. (Caution: the original source rendered this sequence with garbled formatting that looked like plain 3-digit numbers rather than squared primes — always re-derive the actual pattern rather than trusting a confusing transcription.)

Q: Method — simple arithmetic progression (AP) with increasing-by-2 differences: Find the next term: 1, 5, 11, 19, 29, ?

A: Differences: 4, 6, 8, 10 — increasing by 2 each time. Next difference = 12, so next term = $29 + 12 = 41$.

Q: Method — geometric progression (GP): Find the 8th term of 2, 6, 18, 54, ...

A: Common ratio = 3 (each term $\times 3$). Terms: 2, 6, 18, 54, 162, 486, 1458, 4374. The 8th term is 4,374.

Q: Method — plain arithmetic progression, nth term formula: Find the 20th term of 7, 10, 13, ...

A: First term = 7, common difference = 3. nth term = $a + (n-1)d = 7 + (19 \times 3) = 7 + 57 = 64$.

Q: Method — multiples of n^2 : Find the missing number: 3, 12, 27, 48, 75, 108, ____.

A: Each term = $3 \times n^2$ for $n=1, 2, 3, \dots$: $3 \times 1 = 3$, $3 \times 4 = 12$, $3 \times 9 = 27$, $3 \times 16 = 48$, $3 \times 25 = 75$, $3 \times 36 = 108$. Next ($n=7$): $3 \times 49 = 147$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the next term: 2, 9, 28, 65, 126, ?

A. 215

B. 217 ✓

C. 219

D. 221

Explanation: Each term is $n^3 + 1$: $1^3 + 1 = 2$, $2^3 + 1 = 9$, $3^3 + 1 = 28$, $4^3 + 1 = 65$, $5^3 + 1 = 126$. Next: $6^3 + 1 = 216 + 1 = 217$. [hard, authored]

2. Fill in the blank: 2, 7, 14, 23, 34, ____, 62.

A. 45

B. 47 ✓

C. 49

D. 51

Explanation: Differences: 5, 7, 9, 11 — increasing by 2. Next difference = 13, so blank = $34 + 13 = 47$. (Check: $62 - 47 = 15 = 13 + 2$, consistent.) [medium, authored]

3. Find the next term: 3, 7, 15, 27, 43, ?

A. 61

B. 63 ✓

C. 65

D. 67

Explanation: Differences: 4, 8, 12, 16 — increasing by 4. Next difference = 20, so next term = $43 + 20 = 63$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the 7th term of the GP: 3, 9, 27, 81, ...

A. 1,458

B. 2,187 ✓

C. 2,287

D. 1,987

Explanation: Common ratio 3: 3,9,27,81,243,729,2187. 7th term = 2,187. [medium, authored]

5. Find the 15th term of the AP: 5, 9, 13, 17, ...

A. 59

B. 61 ✓

C. 63

D. 65

Explanation: $a=5$, $d=4$. 15th term = $5+(14 \times 4) = 5+56 = 61$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the missing number: 2, 8, 18, 32, 50, ____.

A. 62

B. 68

C. 72 ✓

D. 78

Explanation: Each term = $2 \times n^2$: $2 \times 1=2$, $2 \times 4=8$, $2 \times 9=18$, $2 \times 16=32$, $2 \times 25=50$. Next ($n=6$): $2 \times 36=72$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Tech Bloomers"

READING MATERIAL

A non-fiction piece about how assistive technology empowers people with disabilities, illustrated through two individuals: Alisha, who uses voice-dictation software to study independently, and David, who has Athetoid Cerebral Palsy and uses eye-movement-controlled devices to communicate, study, and even play adaptive sports.

Q: What is the central theme of "Tech Bloomers"?

A: The use of technology for empowerment — specifically, how assistive technology enables people with disabilities to study, communicate, and participate fully in life.

Q: What has technology helped Alisha do, and what software does she use?

A: Technology has helped Alisha study independently. She uses 'Dragon Dictate', a voice-dictation software.

Q: Who introduced Dragon Dictate to Alisha, what is that person's role, and how long did Alisha take to train it?

A: Kim, an Assistive Technologist, introduced Dragon Dictate to Alisha. Alisha took just a few hours to train the software to her voice.

Q: What condition was David born with, and how does he control his 'Liberator' device?

A: David was born with Athetoid Cerebral Palsy. He controls his Liberator device using eye movements.

Q: What additional controller is found in David's chair, and what system helps him select icons with his eyes?

A: A Headrest ACTIV controller is found in his chair. The 'ECO2' system, using an 'ECO point', helps him select icons with his eyes.

Q: What does David use ECO2 for in daily life, and which sport does he NOT play (among the adaptive sports mentioned)?

A: He uses ECO2 to access his curriculum (study materials) and to order food. Among the sports mentioned (Boccia, Hockey, Tennis), he does NOT play Tennis — he plays Boccia and Hockey.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The central theme of "Tech Bloomers" is:

- A. History of technology
- B. Role of AI in warfare
- C. Use of technology for empowerment ✓**
- D. Business automation

Explanation: Use of technology for empowerment. [easy, web-research]

2. Technology has helped Alisha to:

- A. Cook food
- B. Type with her hands
- C. Speak multiple languages
- D. Study independently ✓**

Explanation: Study independently. [medium, web-research]

3. The voice-dictation software Alisha uses is called:

- A. SpeakEasy
- B. Dragon Dictate ✓**
- C. VoiceWrite
- D. Dictation Pro

Explanation: Dragon Dictate. [medium, web-research]

4. Who introduced Dragon Dictate to Alisha, and what was that person's role?

- A. Her doctor
- B. Her classmate
- C. Kim, an Assistive Technologist ✓**
- D. David, an author

Explanation: Kim, an Assistive Technologist. [medium, web-research]

5. How long did it take Alisha to train Dragon Dictate to her voice?

- A. A week
- B. A few hours ✓**
- C. A month
- D. A day

Explanation: A few hours. [medium, web-research]

6. David, in "Tech Bloomers", was born with which condition?

- A. ADHD
- B. Spina bifida
- C. Athetoid Cerebral Palsy ✓**
- D. Dyslexia

Explanation: Athetoid Cerebral Palsy. [medium, web-research]

7. David controls his 'Liberator' device using:

- A. Voice
- B. Hand movements
- C. Eye movements ✓**
- D. Foot taps

Explanation: Eye movements. [medium, web-research]

8. What additional controller is found in David's chair?

- A. Wrist band
- B. Headrest ACTIV controller ✓**
- C. Palm switch
- D. Shoulder joystick

Explanation: Headrest ACTIV controller. [hard, web-research]

9. Which system helps David select icons using his eyes, and what does he use it for?

- A. Dragon Eye — for gaming
- B. SmartSight — for navigation
- C. ECO2 with ECO point — to access curriculum and order food ✓**
- D. BlinkAssist — for typing only

Explanation: ECO2 with ECO point, used to access his curriculum and order food. [hard, web-research]

10. Which sport does David NOT play, among those mentioned in the passage?

- A. Boccia
- B. Hockey
- C. Tennis ✓**
- D. All of the above are played

Explanation: Tennis — he plays Boccia and Hockey. [medium, web-research]